

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 10 8 5 3

♥ K 5

♦ 8 7 4 3

♣ 9 3

♠ 6 2

♥ A 10 9

♦ 10 6 5

♣ K Q 7 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 9 7

♥ 8 7 6 4 2

♦ A 9

♣ 10 8 2

♠ Q J 4

♥ Q J 3

♦ K Q J 2

♣ A J 5

West

North

East

South

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠ 5

started with a 5-card suit. That means East still has a ♠. The instant you play a ♦ one of the defenders will grab the ♦ A and West will take his three more ♠ tricks.

As much as you hate to put your contract in the hands of a 50% finesse chance, that is what you must do. Forget the ♦ suit and finesse West for the ♥ K, trying for two extra tricks in ♥ s.

West played very well to duck the second ♠, leaving his partner with a ♠ in case he could get the lead.

So you have to play well and stay away from ♦ s.

Partner's 2NT bid invites you to bid game if you have a maximum hand. You aren't thrilled by all the Quacks in your hand but with 17 points you bid 3NT.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♠ 5. East wins the first trick with the ♠ K and returns the ♠ 9. West plays the ♠ 3 under your ♠ J.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 5 :: Total = 7

You need 2 more tricks, and the ♦ suit will provide them after you drive out the ♦ A.

Is that what you should do?

That is definitely **NOT** what you should do. West led the ♠ 5, then played the ♠ 3 to the second trick. You have seen the ♠ 4 and ♠ 2 so it is clear that West

Board 2

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 6
♥ 6
♦ K 8 5 4 2
♣ Q 9 3

♠ A K 5 4

♥ A 3 2

♦ Q J 10

♣ J 7 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 8 3 2
♥ 10 4
♦ 9 7 6 3
♣ K 10 5

♠ 7

♥ K Q J 9 8 7 5

♦ A

♣ A 8 4 2

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♠	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

6♥ by South

Lead: ♠Q

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 3 :: Total = 3

There would be nothing wrong with a transfer bid here, but probably no advantage either. What you really want to know is how many Aces partner has. So you ask him with a Gerber 4♣ bid.

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Partner says 4♠ (2 Aces),

Looking at three possible ♣ losers you bid 6♥.

South plays 6♥. West leads the ♠Q. The first trick is easy; you win with dummy's ♠A.

It can't do any good to ruff your fourth ♣ in dummy because you would have to lose two before that could happen. Of course one of your ♣s can be discarded on dummy's ♠K but what about the other two?

Suppose you win the ♠ and unblock the ♦A. Play ♥K, then to dummy's ♥A. Take one ♣ discard on the ♠K, then play the ♦Q and discard a second ♣.

It won't work. You would establish the ♦ for your last discard but you have no entry to it.

This will work. At trick 2 discard the ♦A on dummy's ♠K. Play the ♦Q and discard a ♣ when East doesn't cover. West will take the ♦K and attack ♣s but you are in control now. You win your ♣A, pull trumps, ending in dummy, and discard the remaining 2 ♣ losers on dummy's ♦J 10.

This is called a Jettison play. You sacrifice your ♦A to unblock the suit for dummy's ♦Q J 10.

If East held the ♦K the play would be slightly different; you would have to ruff when he covered. But the result would be the same.

Did you notice that you started with 3 ♣ losers and no ♦ loser, but you ended up losing 1 ♦ and no ♣s?

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J
 ♥ K Q 3
 ♦ Q J 10 9 6 5
 ♣ 7 6

♠ 8 4 3
 ♥ 9 5
 ♦ A 7 3
 ♣ K Q 9 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 7 6 5
 ♥ J 10 6 2
 ♦ 8
 ♣ A 8 4 2

♠ A K 9 2
 ♥ A 8 7 4
 ♦ K 4 2
 ♣ J 10

West	North	East	South
			1NT
2♦	2NT	Pass	3♣
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South

Lead: ♦ Q

up and West plays another ♦, no harm will be done. But probably no good will be done either because West is likely to have 6 ♦s, leaving East with just a singleton anyway. But what if West pockets the one ♦ trick and switches to ♥s, a suit where you only have one stopper? Since that might turn out badly, you should **NOT** hold up.

As to which hand to win it in, that's easy. You need to preserve any dummy entries that you can so you win the first trick with your ♦K.

Now you establish some ♣ winners. You play the ♣J and both defenders play low.

You have to assume that defenders good enough to hold up their ♣A at the first opportunity will be good enough to do it on the second play also. But you can thwart them by next playing your ♣10 and overtaking with dummy's ♣Q. Even if they do hold up again you can continue with another ♣ from dummy to establish the suit while you still have the ♦A for an entry.

If you fail to overtake the second ♣ East will hold up the ♣A again.

Then you will lose all those ♣ tricks in dummy.

Partner's 2NT is the lebensohl convention. He requests that you bid 3♣ as a relay, which you do. Partner now bids 3NT.

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When partner bids 3NT AFTER the lebensohl 2NT, he is suggesting you play there, and he guarantees a stopper in their suit. You are happy to pass.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♦ Q. West attacks in ♦s and you must make an immediate choice. Hold up, win in dummy, or win in your hand.

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 5

First decide about what to do at trick #1. If you hold

Board 4

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 6 4

♥ 7 4

♦ 9 6 3

♣ Q 8 4 2

♠ 5 3

♥ A J 8 6 2

♦ 7 5 2

♣ K J 9



♠ K J 7

♥ K 5 3

♦ A Q J 8

♣ 7 5 3

♠ A Q 8 2

♥ Q 10 9

♦ K 10 4

♣ A 10 6

West	North	East	South
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Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
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Pass	3NT	Pass	4♥
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All Pass

4♥ by South

Lead: ♦9

The question is: Do you use Transfers after a 1NT OVERCALL? And in particular, can you bid the opponent's suit and have it mean a transfer instead of a cue-bid? This is something you and your partner need to agree on - as for me and my partner, we think 2♦ is a transfer. Partner replies 2♥.

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With 10 points you are between Invitational and Game-forcing. Which means you bid either 2NT or 3NT, whichever suits your fancy. Today let's say it is 3NT which partner converts to 4♥.

The contract would be 4♥ played by North.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♦9. East wins the first trick with the ♦A, then plays ♦Q. You take your ♦K now, fearing that the next one could be ruffed by West.

Loser List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 5

You hope East, who opened the bidding, (as West before the hands were rotated), will have the ♠K, which would reduce your losers to 4.

You win the second ♦ and play your ♥Q, taken by East with the ♥K. He cashes the ♦J, West following, then exits with a small ♥.

Win this trump and play one more, pulling East's last trump and ending in dummy. Play a ♠ to your ♠Q (which wins) then play ♠A and ruff a ♠ in dummy. East follows with the ♠7, ♠J and ♠K. Now you must try the ♣ finesse, but through whom?

Is it a 50-50 guess? Or is East more likely to have the ♣Q since he had the opening hand?

No, it is not a 50-50 guess. No, East doesn't have the ♣Q, West does. If you watched the cards that East has played you will realize he started with 3-3-4-3 distribution. You will also know that he started with 14 points outside the ♣ suit. If he had the ♣Q he would have a balanced 16 point hand and would have opened 1NT, not 1♦. So West has the ♣Q.

You can go through 100 hands and on 99 of them it won't matter if you pay attention to the cards played by the defenders or not.

But if you don't pay attention on all 100 of them you will miss the one time where your attention was needed.